

EGERTON



UNIVERSITY

Department of Literature, Languages and Linguistics

COMS 111: INTRODUCTION TO ACADEMIC COMMUNICATION SKILLS 3.0 CF

COURSE OUTLINE

Purpose of the course

COMS 111 is a skills-based course whose main purpose is to equip learners with guidance and practice on academic communication skills that they will apply in their specific areas of discipline.

Expected Learning outcomes

By the end of this course, learners should be able to:

1. Demonstrate understanding of the relationship between the communication process and academic communication
2. Utilize effective college level study skills
3. Use effective listening skills
4. Analyse different types of written texts
5. Make effective use of Library resources
6. Practice effective academic writing techniques

Week 1&2: What is communication?

- (a) The process of communication
- (b) Communication models
- (c) Types of communication
- (d) Barriers of communication
- (e) Communication and academics

- (c) Organization of information sources
- (d) Evaluation of information sources

Week 3&4: Study Skills

- (a) Effective listening skills
- (b) Note taking
- (c) Barriers to effective listening
- (d) Effective study skills

Week 7&8: Academic reading

- (a) The reading process
- (b) Study Reading Formula
- (c) Critical reading
- (d) Types of reading texts

Week 5&6: Library user skills

- (a) Types of Library
- (b) Information sources – types and categories

Week 9&10: Academic writing

- (a) Features of academic writing
- (b) The academic writing process
- (c) Essay writing
- (d) Referencing sources

Instructional Methods and Equipment

Online lectures
Reading assignments
Discussion forums

Student chat forums
Studying samples
Library visit

Instructional Materials

Handouts
Presentations and online tutorials
Supplementary e-resources
Links to Audio-visuals

Student assessment at course level

Type	Weighting (%)
Continuous Assessment	30%
End of semester exam	70%

Core Reading Materials for the Course

1. Study materials and handouts and uploaded on the COMS 111 **E-learning platform**.

Recommended Reference Materials for the course

Drew, C. (February 23, 2020). *All 8 Models of Communication, Explained!* Helpful Professor. <https://helpfulprofessor.com/communication-models/>
<https://www.yourarticlelibrary.com/management/communication/top-11-barriers-to-communication-2/64040>

Savitsky, Y. (2019, April, 30) *How a student changed her study habits by setting goals and managing time* [Video] TED
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=z7e7gtU3PHY>

Weerasinghe, T. & Thisera, T. J. R. (2014) Keys to Effective Listening and Presenting: An Action Plan. *Kelaniya Journal of Human Resource Management*. Vol. 9(1-2), pp.33–48. <http://doi.org/10.4038/kjhrm.v9i1-2.11>

Presentation skills. <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=V8eLdbKXGzk>

Reading skills for academic study: Understanding texts.

<http://www.uefap.com/reading/readframund.htm>

Lowe, W. (2013, April 8) *Basic Academic writing skills* [Video]
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2F_KH_cs6RY